

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science Stanford University	maemac@stanford.edu www.maemacdonald.com
EDUCATION	Stanford University Stanford, CA 2021–2027 (expected) Ph.D., Department of Political Science - Committee: James D. Fearon (co-chair), Jeremy Weinstein (co-chair), Judith Goldstein (on leave), Jens Hainmueller, and Michael Allen - Knight-Hennessy Scholar University of Oxford Oxford, UK 2015–2018 B.A., Philosophy, Politics, and Economics (<i>Double First Class</i>)	
RESEARCH INTERESTS	International political economy; international security; forced displacement and migration; foreign aid and development; international organizations; violence; Africa.	
PUBLICATIONS	Lisa Blaydes, James D. Fearon, and Mae MacDonald . 2025. “Understanding Intimate Partner Violence.” <i>Annual Review of Political Science</i> 28:351–374.	
WORKING PAPERS	Mae MacDonald . “Peace or Push? Understanding Global Patterns of Refugee Return.” Mae MacDonald . “Aid Cuts and the Politics of Refugee Hosting.” <i>Immigration Policy Lab Working Paper Series</i> . Under review. Sigrid Weber, Mae MacDonald , Adam Lichtenheld, Jessica Wolff, Alex Wendo, Annet Adong, Clare Clingain, David Musiime, Andrew Zeitlin, and Jens Hainmueller. “Does Building Business Networks Strengthen Refugee Economic and Social Integration?” Mae MacDonald and Adam Lichtenheld. “Beyond Encampment? Understanding Attitudes Toward Refugee Integration.” <i>Immigration Policy Lab Working Paper Series</i> . Under review. Mae MacDonald , Alexander Yeandle, Ryan Jablonski, and Brigitte Seim. “Partisanship and Blame Attribution for Foreign Aid Cuts in the Global South.”	
WORKS IN PROGRESS	Mae MacDonald . “Cooperation with the International Refugee Regime.” <i>Book project</i> . Mae MacDonald . “U.S. Foreign Policy Shocks and Attitudes Toward Great Powers.”	
POLICY AND PUBLIC WRITING	Mae MacDonald , Adam Lichtenheld, and Tolossa Asrat. 2025. “Kenya Embraces Refugee Integration – and Citizens Are on Board.” <i>The New Humanitarian</i> . Reprinted in <i>The EastAfrican</i> , a Kenyan newspaper.	

Mae MacDonald. 2025. “Rapid Response Evidence: Tracking the Impact of US Aid Cuts in Kakuma Refugee Camp.” Policy Brief for UN Refugee Agency.

Mae MacDonald. 2024. “Tackling Small Boats and Building Global Resilience: A Twofold Policy Plan on Refugees.” Policy Brief commissioned by the UK Cabinet Office, King’s College London Centre for Grand Strategy.

AWARDS AND HONORS

Centennial Teaching Assistant Award, Stanford University 2026
Award recognizing outstanding teaching assistants at Stanford.

Diversifying Academia, Recruiting Excellence (DARE) Fellow, Stanford University 2025
Competitive (1 year) full-tuition graduate fellowship for students who will diversify the professoriate.

Ric Weiland Graduate Fellow, Stanford University 2024
Award to 20 exceptional Ph.D. students across the Humanities & Sciences.

Carnegie International Policy Fellow, Johns Hopkins University 2024
Fellowship and network for scholars at the intersection of policy and research.

Enhancing Diversity in Graduate Education (EDGE) Fellow, Stanford University 2021
Competitive graduate fellowship for early-stage students from underrepresented backgrounds.

Knight-Hennessy Scholar, Stanford University 2021
Competitive (3 year) full-tuition graduate fellowship (similar to the Rhodes Scholarship in the UK).

YouGov Fellowship, University of Oxford 2018
Award for graduate and undergraduate students to conduct their dissertation research through YouGov’s survey platform.

E.T. Warner Prize for Excellence in Philosophy, Politics, and Economics, University of Oxford 2018
Award for academic excellence in P.P.E. at Christ Church college.

Academic Scholar, University of Oxford 2016
Award for academic merit following first-year examinations.

Crankstart Scholar, University of Oxford 2015
Award for undergraduate students from lower-income households.

GRANTS

Stanford School of Humanities & Sciences GRO (\$5,495) 2026

J-PAL/IPA Displaced Livelihoods Initiative (\$60,000) 2024
with Jeremy Weinstein and Adam Lichtenheld

Stanford Institute for Economics Policy Research (\$5,200) 2024

Ric Weiland Graduate Fellowship (\$4,000) 2024

King Center on Global Development (\$25,000) 2023
with Jeremy Weinstein and Adam Lichtenheld

J-PAL/IPA Displaced Livelihoods Initiative (\$10,000) 2023

	Freeman Spogli Institute for International Studies (\$9,000)	2023
	Stanford Europe Center (\$1,000)	2023
	King Center on Global Development (\$5,000)	2023
	Sohaib and Sara Abbasi Program in Islamic Studies (\$3,000)	2023
	Stanford Impact Labs (\$4,000) with Jens Hainmueller	2022
	King Center on Global Development (\$8,000)	2022
	Stanford Institute for Research in the Social Sciences (\$1,500)	2022
	Stanford EDGE (\$6,000)	2021
	YouGov Fellowship (\$12,000)	2018
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	YouGov , Graduate Researcher (Public Sector), UK	2018–2019
	Movement on the Ground , Refugee Camp Volunteer, Greece	2021
	CalAid , Refugee Camp Volunteer, Greece	2017
	The Entrepreneurial Refugee Network , Intern, UK	2017
	Global Policy Institute , Research Intern, UK	2017
	Political Party , Intern, UK	2015
	House of Commons , Intern, UK	2014
TEACHING	Teaching Assistant , Stanford University	
	• Introduction to International Relations (James D. Fearon), Fall 2024	
	• War and Peace in American Foreign Policy (Kenneth Schultz), Spring 2024	
	• Introduction to International Relations (James D. Fearon), Fall 2022	
	Class Co-Coordinator , Stanford University	
	• Climate Displacement, Migration, and Mobility (Chris Field), Spring 2025	
	Research Assistant (RA) Supervision	
DATASETS	• Policy Research Internship Supervisor (34 RAs), University of California Washington Program with the Political Violence Lab, 2025–2026	
	• Undergraduate Research Supervisor (3 RAs), Stanford IRiSS Research Assistant Internship Program, 2023–2025	
	• Undergraduate Research Supervisor (2 RAs), Stanford University, 2023–present	
	Global Refugee Return (GRR) Dataset. Original dataset of all protracted refugee situations (293 origin–asylum dyads; 1980–2023) that corrects errors in UNHCR stock and repatriation figures, and introduces new indicators of <i>de facto</i> asylum conditions and forced return practices. Coded with the help of 36 research assistants. <i>Forthcoming</i> .	
	UNHCR Funding Dataset. Donor-level contributions to the UN Refugee Agency and country-level allocation of expenditures within recipient countries. <i>Forthcoming</i> .	

TALKS AND CONFERENCES	Scheduled: American Political Science Association (APSA); Peace Science Society (International) Annual Meeting. 2026: Online Peace Science Colloquium; Yale Research Initiative on Innovation & Scale (Y-RISE) International Conference on Migration and Development; World Bank-UNHCR Joint Data Center on Forced Displacement Research Conference; Berlin Meeting on the Political Economy of Development (MoPED); Berkeley-Stanford IPE Colloquium; Immigration Policy Lab Workshop; APSA Dissertation Workshop Series (Migration and Citizenship); Stanford International Affairs Society. 2025: American Political Science Association (APSA); World Bank-UNHCR Joint Data Center on Forced Displacement Research Conference; Forced Displacement Working Group (FDWG), Penn Development Research Initiative; Immigration Policy Lab Workshop. 2024: American Political Science Association (APSA); International Studies Association (ISA); APSA Migration & Citizenship Section Dissertation Workshop; UNHCR-IPA Evidence in Action: Displaced Livelihoods Initiative in Africa; Immigration Policy Lab Workshop.
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	Immigration Policy Lab, Stanford University Forced Displacement Working Group, Penn Development Research Initiative (PDRI-DevLab), University of Pennsylvania Centre for Grand Strategy, War Studies Department, King’s College London Carnegie International Policy Scholars Consortium and Network (IPSCON), Henry A. Kissinger Center for Global Affairs, Johns Hopkins University Political Violence Lab, University of California Merced
SERVICE	Reviewer <i>Journal of Conflict Resolution, Journal of Immigrant & Refugee Studies</i> Mentorship • Refugee-Led Research Hub (East Africa), 2023 • Young African Research Network (YARN), 2024 • Stanford Political Science Pathways to PhD, 2023 • Stanford IRiSS Research Assistant Internship Program, 2023-2024 • Stanford First Year Graduate Student Mentor, 2023
SKILLS AND FIELDWORK	Computing: R, L^AT_EX, Python, QGIS, Google Earth Engine (GEE) Fieldwork: Kenya (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025); Uganda (2022, 2023); Thailand (2022); Greece (2016, 2021); UK (2017) Additional training: Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, Syracuse University (2023) Languages: English (native); French (intermediate) Archives: UNHCR (2023)